

7.2 RECEIPT ORGANIZATION SYSTEM

Why Receipt Organization Matters

Proper receipt organization is essential for:

- Tracking expenses accurately and staying within budget
- Warranty claims and returns
- Tax deductions and documentation for the IRS
- Insurance claims in case of loss or damage
- Resolving payment disputes with vendors
- Proving costs if you sell the property

Receipt Organization Instructions

1. Label Envelopes or Folders by Month and Category

Create a filing system using large envelopes, accordion folders, or a filing box. Label each section with:

- Month and Year (e.g., "January 2024")
- Budget Category (see list below)

Example: "January 2024 - Foundation" or "March 2024 - Framing"

2. File Receipts Immediately

When you return from a purchase or receive a receipt:

- Record the expense in your Expense Tracking Sheet (Section 7.1) the same day
- Write the corresponding expense log entry number on the receipt
- File the receipt in the appropriate envelope/folder immediately
- Check the "Receipt Filed" box in your expense log
- Note the receipt location (envelope/folder label) in your expense log

3. Note Any Missing² Receipts

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If you cannot locate a receipt:

- Mark "N" for Receipt Filed in your expense log
- Write "MISSING RECEIPT" in the Receipt Location column
- Try to obtain a duplicate from the vendor
- If unavailable, write a memo documenting the purchase (date, vendor, amount, items purchased)
- Attach credit card/bank statement showing the transaction

4. Digital Backup Recommended

To protect against loss or damage:

- Scan or photograph all receipts (especially thermal receipts that fade)
- Store digital copies in organized folders on your computer or cloud storage
- Use the same naming convention: "2024-01-Foundation-Receipt-001.pdf"
- Back up digital files regularly to an external drive or cloud service

Receipt Organization Categories

Organize your receipts using these budget categories. Create a separate envelope or folder section for each:

☐	Category	Examples of Items/Services
☐	Site Preparation	Clearing, grading, excavation, driveway
☐	Foundation	Concrete, rebar, forms, waterproofing, footer materials
☐	Framing	Lumber, engineered beams, joists, sheathing, fasteners
☐	Roofing	Shingles, underlayment, drip edge, vents, flashing
☐	Exterior	Siding, windows, doors, trim, house wrap
☐	Rough-In	Plumbing pipes, electrical wire, HVAC equipment, fixtures
☐	Insulation	Fiberglass batts, spray foam, rigid foam boards
☐	Drywall	Drywall sheets, joint compound, tape, screws
☐	Flooring	Hardwood, tile, carpet, underlayment, adhesives
☐	Cabinets	Kitchen cabinets, bathroom vanities, countertops
☐	Fixtures	Sinks, toilets, faucets, light fixtures, appliances
☐	Paint	Interior paint, exterior paint, primer, brushes, rollers
☐	Permits	Building permits, inspection fees, impact fees
☐	Other	Landscaping, garage door, miscellaneous hardware

Receipt Storage Checklist

☐ Envelopes or folders labeled with month and category

☐ All receipts filed within 24 hours of purchase

☐ Receipt numbers match expense log entries

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☐ Missing receipts documented with memos and statements

- ☐ Digital backup system established
- ☐ Receipts scanned or photographed weekly
- ☐ Digital files backed up to cloud or external drive
- ☐ Receipt storage kept in secure, dry location
- ☐ All receipts retained for at least 7 years after project completion

Notes
